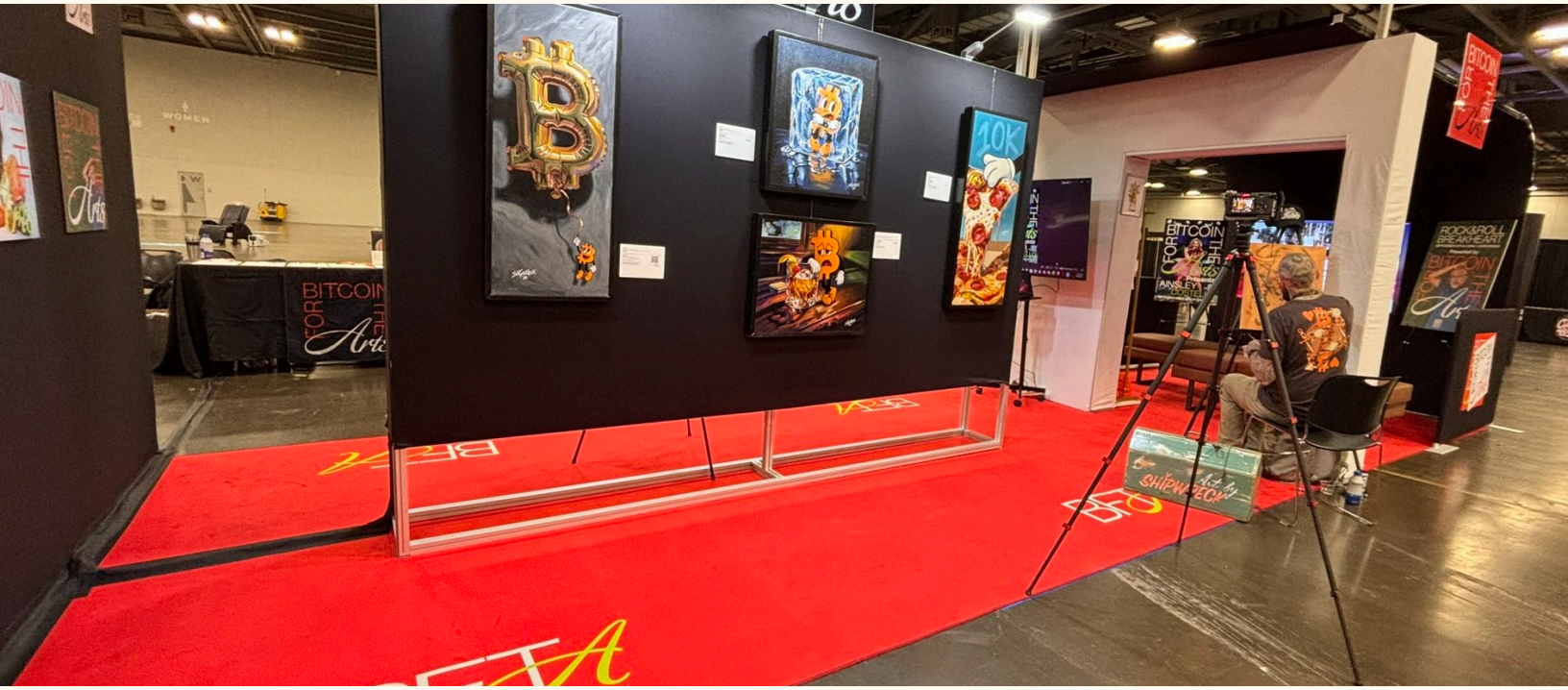
BALTIMORE · WINTER 2026 TO 2027

# SOUND MONEY, ART, AND BALTIMORE

A plain-English class for artists on sound money: why the dollar buys less every year, why bitcoin was built so it can't be printed, and how artists are using it to get paid directly. Taught at Stem & Vine by a Baltimore native, built so the evening pays for itself and earns Stem & Vine money.




**WHAT**
A 90-minute class, then an art and music evening if it goes well

**WHERE**
The Stem Room
326 N. Charles Street

**WHO**
Baltimore artists, and anyone curious about sound money

**YOUR RISK**
None. Your room fee is guaranteed



501(C)(3) · EIN 41-2642260

WHO WE ARE

# A NONPROFIT THAT TEACHES ARTISTS SOUND MONEY

Bitcoin For The Arts, Inc. is a New York 501(c)(3). We do three things: we give grants to working artists, paid in bitcoin; we teach artists sound money and how bitcoin works; and we bring art and live performance into Bitcoin spaces.

Sound money is a new idea for most people, and a different way of thinking about money altogether. It means money that no one can print more of, so the value of your work holds over time. Bitcoin is that money. We use the words "sound money" because they open the conversation before the word "bitcoin" closes it.

We do not sell anything. We do not give investment advice, and nobody in our classes is asked to buy anything. The goal is understanding.

## Why Dion is coming home to teach this

Dion Wilson grew up in Baltimore and studied at the Baltimore School for the Arts. He danced professionally for 16 years, including the national tour of Disney's *The Lion King*. When his dance career ended, he went looking for how money really works, found bitcoin and sound money, and founded Bitcoin For The Arts to teach other artists what he learned.

This class is his way of giving back to the city that trained him.

## What we have done in our first year

- Produced Bitcoin Arts Park at the Midwest Bitcoin Summit in Columbus, September 2026: live music, theater, live painting, film, and a silent auction. Every artist was paid.
- Shown work and spoken at Bitcoin events in Las Vegas, Portland, and New Hampshire.
- Released 18 episodes of our interview show, *Share Your Bitcoin Journey*, and eight free classes anyone can use.
- Awarded $3,900 in grants to three artists this fall.
- Published our board minutes and finances at bitcoinforthearts.org/transparency.

## What the sound money class covers, in plain English

No jargon and no math. If someone has never heard the word bitcoin, they will be fine.

### Why the dollar buys less

When more dollars are printed, each one buys less. Artists feel this first, because fees and grants rarely keep up.

### What "sound money" means

Money no one can print more of. Its supply is fixed, so savings and the value of your work hold over time.

### Why bitcoin is sound money

Only 21 million bitcoin will ever exist. No bank or government can make more. That is the whole idea.

### Getting paid directly

How a fan or collector can pay an artist in bitcoin, from a phone, with no middleman taking a cut.








Bitcoin Arts Park, Midwest Bitcoin Summit, Columbus, Ohio, September 2026.

HOW STEM & VINE EARNS

# FIVE WAYS TO WORK TOGETHER

Each option starts with the same promise: Stem & Vine is paid for the room first, every time. The numbers below are starting points for a conversation, not a contract.

Our promise: if ticket sales do not cover your room fee, Bitcoin For The Arts pays the difference. You never host this at a loss.

OPTION 1 · SIMPLE RENTAL

### We rent the Stem Room

Bitcoin For The Arts books the Stem Room at your standard rate and teaches a free class for local artists. You earn the full rental plus anything guests buy from you that evening.

Two hours, Sunday to Wednesday: $250. Thursday to Saturday: $300. Plus your usual taxes and service charges.

OPTION 2 · TICKETED CLASS

### We sell tickets together

A 90-minute class in the Stem Room for up to 18 people, at about $30 a ticket. Ticket money pays your room fee first. Anything left is split 50/50. Food and drink sales stay with you.

Best for a first event. Low effort, easy to measure. The $30 price and the split are suggestions.

OPTION 3 · ART AND MUSIC EVENING

### A bigger night in the gallery

Work by Baltimore artists on the walls, a short live performance, a 20-minute talk, and a reception. Sized to the gallery, not the 18-seat classroom, so more tickets, art sales, and a bar. We would also look for a local sponsor to cover costs before a single ticket is sold.

Art sales: the artist keeps most of each sale. The commission share is agreed in advance.

OPTION 4 · A SERIES

### Four classes, one pass

Our four-part course, one evening a month, sold as a pass of about $100 for all four. Repeat visitors and steady income on nights the room might sit empty.

Same rule as Option 2: room fee first, then a 50/50 split.

OPTION 5 · FILM OUR SHOW IN YOUR SPACE

### Record *Share Your Bitcoin Journey* at Stem & Vine

Your plants and gallery make a beautiful set. We would rent the space at your rate to film an episode with a Baltimore artist. Every episode recorded there names Stem & Vine on screen and links to you, and it lives on our YouTube channel and podcast feeds for years.

## Option 2, worked out

| A SOLD-OUT WEEKNIGHT | AMOUNT |
|---|---|
| 18 tickets at $30 | $540 |
| Stem & Vine room fee, paid first | $250 |
| Left to split 50/50 | $290 |
| **Stem & Vine total, before food and drink** | **$395** |
| Bitcoin For The Arts share | $145 |

If only 6 tickets sell ($180), Stem & Vine still receives the full $250. We cover the $70.

## What else Stem & Vine gets

- New guests who may come back for your other events and rentals.
- Promotion to our newsletter, podcast audience, and social channels, with Stem & Vine named as host.
- Baltimore artists in your community eligible to apply for our grants.
- Your rate card already lists sats. We can show your team how to accept them.

GETTING STARTED

# A SMALL FIRST STEP

## How we would begin

01 **See a class first.** Tiffany and any of the Stem & Vine team are welcome at our free online class, "What Is Money?", on Monday, November 9, 2026, at 7 PM Eastern. All four classes are Mondays at 7 PM. Sign up at bitcoinforthearts.org/education/webinar#signup.

02 **Pick one option and one date.** We suggest starting with Option 2 on a weeknight early in 2027.

03 **Put it in writing.** A one-page agreement: the date, the room fee, the ticket price, the split, and who pays what.

04 **Run it and review it.** After the first night we share the numbers and decide together whether to do more.

## Stem & Vine provides

- The Stem Room, set up for classroom seating.
- Ticketing, through your usual system, so the money comes to you first.
- Food and drink, if you would like to offer it.
- A staff member on site during the event.

## Bitcoin For The Arts provides

- The teacher, the slides, and handouts for every guest.
- Promotion to our audience, with Stem & Vine as the named host.
- Outreach to Baltimore artists, including the School for the Arts alumni network.
- Any shortfall in your room fee, as promised.

## Questions your team may ask

**Is this a crypto sales pitch?**
No. We teach sound money and how bitcoin works. We sell nothing and give no investment advice.

**Do guests need to own bitcoin?**
No. Most of the people in our classes have never used it.

**Is this legal?**
Yes. Bitcoin is legal to own and use in the United States.

**Who is the audience?**
Working artists first: musicians, painters, dancers, writers. Also patrons, students, and curious neighbors.

## Read more before you decide

- About us: bitcoinforthearts.org
- Class sign-up: bitcoinforthearts.org/education/webinar#signup
- Board minutes and finances: bitcoinforthearts.org/transparency
- Artist interviews: youtube.com/@BitcoinForTheArts
- Stories: bitcoinforthearts.org/stories

CONTACT

**Dion Wilson**
Founder and Executive Director
dionwilson@bitcoinforthearts.org

WHY THIS MATTERS

Artists are the first to feel it when money buys less: fees that stay flat, grants that shrink, savings that fade. Most have never had anyone explain why. Stem & Vine already brings art, hospitality, and community into one room. We would like to add one more thing to that room: a clear, friendly conversation about sound money, for the artists of the city that raised me.

**Dion Wilson, Baltimore School for the Arts**